

Dr. Shuang Song

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EDUCATION BACKGROUND

Ph.D. in Physical Geography Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China, 100875.	01/09/2018 - 30/06/2023
Study of History (Double Major) Sun Yat-sen University, Guangdong, China, 510275.	01/09/2014 - 30/06/2018
B.S. of Science, Physical Geography Sun Yat-sen University, Guangdong, China, 510275.	01/09/2014 - 30/06/2018

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Postdoctoral Researcher Department of Co-evolution of Land Use and Urbanisation, Max Planck Institute of Geoanthropology, Jena, Germany, 07745.	01/01/2026 - present
Postdoctoral Researcher Department of Co-evolution of Land Use and Urbanisation & Department Structural Changes of the Technosphere, Max Planck Institute of Geoanthropology, Jena, Germany, 07745.	01/10/2024 - 31/12/2025
Postdoctoral Researcher School of Environment & RDC for Watershed Environmental Eco-Engineering, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China, 100875.	01/07/2023 - 31/03/2025
Doctoral Researcher State Key Laboratory of Earth Surface Processes and Resource Ecology, Faculty of Geography, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China, 100875.	07/10/2017 - 30/06/2023
Teaching Assistant of Landscape Ecology Faculty of Geography, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China, 100875.	01/09/2019 - 10/01/2020

FUNDED SCIENTIFIC PROJECTS

[Co-PI] Water - food - energy - ecosystem nexus in the Yellow River Basin from the perspective of reservoir operation

NSFC General Fund (Grantee: Xutong Wu, **Shuang Song**, 450,000 CNY) 2025-2028

This project aims to reveal the water-food-energy-ecosystem nexus in the Yellow River Basin, centering on the chain of "ecological restoration - water and sediment changes - reservoir operations - downstream food production", and to explore optimized operation strategies for the Xiaolangdi Reservoir under various scenarios that balance the needs for sediment reduction, hydropower generation, and irrigation. The findings will provide new insights into the water-food-energy-ecosystem nexus and offer a scientific basis for ecological conservation and high-quality development of the Yellow River Basin, thereby holding significant scientific and practical value.

[Principal Investigator] Simulation and Optimization of Agricultural Irrigation Water Use in the Yellow River Basin by Agent-based Modeling

NSFC Young Scientists Fund (Grantee: **Shuang Song**, 300,000 CNY) 2024-2027

This project focuses on developing an agent-based model to simulate agricultural irrigation under various climate and policy scenarios. By integrating agent adaptability with public goods theory, we aim to identify the key drivers of changes in water use and predict future irrigation demand in response to climate shifts. This work builds on my previous experience with human-environment system modelling, directly contributing to future water management strategies in the river basin.

[Participate] Human Management of the Water Cycle in a Global Comparative Perspective*Joint Funded by Max-Planck Society (Grantee: Jürgen Renn, 200,000 ERU)*

2024-2025

The research plan operates across three integrated focus areas: Geoanthropology, real-time data integration, and water scarcity. This project aims to establish a global network of partners for global comparative studies. In this project, I collect water resource management case studies from around the world, create data visualisations, and network international partners.

[Participate] Coordination mechanism and regulation strategy of multiple processes of water-sediment-ecology-economy system in the Yellow River Basin*NSFC Joint Funds & Yellow River Water Science Funds (Grantee: Enhui Jiang, 11,720,000 CNY)*

2023-2026

As a key participant in this interdisciplinary project, I contributed to the development of a coordinated strategy to manage the interconnected water-sediment-ecology-economy system of the Yellow River Basin. My role included research design, data collection, data analysis, and report drafting. The project explores the feedback mechanisms between environmental changes and socio-economic dynamics, with implications for long-term sustainability.

[Participate] Mechanisms of human-natural system coupling and optimization of the Yellow River Basin*NSFC National Major Research Plan (Grantee: Bojie Fu, 17,000,000 CNY)*

2021-2025

This large-scale project investigates the coupling mechanisms between human and natural systems, focusing on optimization strategies for sustainable development in the Yellow River Basin. My contributions spanned data analysis, report writing, and project coordination. The research outcomes have been instrumental in improving socio-hydrological models and enhancing our understanding of long-term water resource management.

[Participate] Sustainability of the socio-hydrological system*NSFC Excellent Young Scientists Fund (Grantee: Shuai Wang, 1,300,000 CNY)*

2017-2020

This project aimed to improve mathematical models of socio-hydrology by examining the dynamic interactions between human activities and water systems in the Yellow River Basin. I was involved in the project's theoretical and empirical aspects, including data collection, model development, and the publication of findings. This experience directly supports my current research on the long-term resilience of human-environment systems.

PUBLICATIONS

Dr. Shuang Song has published in the leading journals, such as *Nature Communications*, *Water Resources Research*, *Journal of Hydrology*, *Hydrology and Earth System Science*, and *Nature Sustainability*. Listed below are the 10 published or accepted articles with Dr. Song as **first or corresponding author**; for the complete list, including manuscripts under review, please visit <https://cv.songshgeo.com/publication/>.

- [1] Hu, B., **Song, S.***, Wang, Y., Zhang, X., Liu, Y., et al. **2026a**. "Memory Sources Shape Flood Risk Perception and Agricultural Decision Among Farmers in a Drought-Oriented Irrigation District". en. In: *Journal of Flood Risk Management* 19.3, e70244. DOI: 10.1111/jfr3.70244.
- [2] **Song, S.***, Zhang, L., Renn, J., and Roberts, P. **2026d**. "From Regime Shifts to Adaptive Cycles: Dynamic Understanding of Human–Water System". en-US. In: *Environmental Research: Water* 2.2. DOI: 10.1088/3033-4942/ae609a.
- [3] **Song, S.**, Wang, S.* , Jiao, C., and Ibarra, E. J. M. **2024b**. "ABSESpy: An agent-based modeling framework for social-ecological systems". en. In: *Journal of Open Source Software* 9.96, p. 6298. DOI: 10.21105/joss.06298.
- [4] **Song, S.**, Wen, H., Wang, S., Wu, X., Cumming, G. S., et al. **2024d**. "Quantifying the effects of institutional shifts on water governance in the Yellow River Basin: A social-ecological system perspective". en-US. In: *Journal of Hydrology* 629, p. 130638. DOI: 10.1016/j.jhydrol.2024.130638.
- [5] **Song, S.**, Wang, S.* , Wu, X., Wei, Y., Cumming, G. S., et al. **2023c**. "Identifying Regime Transitions for Water Governance in the Yellow River Basin, China". en. In: *Water Resources Research* 59.12, e2022WR033819. DOI: 10.1029/2022WR033819.
- [6] **Song, S.**, Wang, S.* , Wu, X., Huang, Y., and Fu, B. **2022b**. "Decreased virtual water outflows from the Yellow River basin are increasingly critical to China". en-US. In: *Hydrology and Earth System Sciences* 26.8, pp. 2035–2044. DOI: 10.5194/hess-26-2035-2022.

- [7] **Song, S.**, Du, J. *, Wu, Q., Ni, M., Wang, Y., et al. **2021c**. “The responses of *Spinifex littoreus* to sand burial on the coastal area of Pingtan Island, Fujian Province, South China”. en. In: *Écoscience*, pp. 1–10. DOI: 10.1080/11956860.2021.1888523.
- [8] **Song, S.**, Wang, S. *, Fu, B., Dong, Y., Liu, Y., et al. **2021d**. “Improving representation of collective memory in socio-hydrological models and new insights into flood risk management”. en. In: *Journal of Flood Risk Management* 14.1. DOI: 10.1111/jfr3.12679.
- [9] **Song, S.**, Wang, S. *, Fu, B., Liu, Y., Wang, K., et al. **2020**. “Sediment transport under increasing anthropogenic stress: Regime shifts within the Yellow River, China”. en-US. In: *Ambio* 49.12, pp. 2015–2025. DOI: 10.1007/s13280-020-01350-8.
- [10] **Song, S.**, Wang, S. *, Fu, B., Chen, H., Liu, Y., et al. **2019a**. “Study on adaptive governance of social-ecological system: Progress and prospect”. zh-CN. In: *Acta Geographica Sinica* 74.11, pp. 2401–2410.

* = Corresponding author

OUTREACH PROJECT EXPERIENCE

[Co-PI] Ecosystem services in Inner Mongolia

Inner Mongolia Key Scientific Project (Grantee: **Joint sources**)

2021-present

In this project, we examine Inner Mongolian grassland communities to explain the dangers posed by ecological degradation. I have gone deep into the grasslands four times to conduct interviews and research with local herders to understand ecological issues.

[Personal Project] Popular Blogs: A geographer who also travels

Monthly publish articles on <https://songshgeo.com/>

2018-present

In this series of writings, I position myself as “A Geographer who also travels.” I write in Chinese, combining geographic knowledge, academic concepts, and travel experiences, and convey them to the public in an easy-to-understand language. I have earned 4,688 CNY tips for this blog, with 812 subscriptions and readership. The webpage has around 4,000 visitors.

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATIONS

[Oral Presentation] Millennial-scale data reveals a collective memory of extreme drought and flood events.

University of Tokyo, Tokyo, Japan

20/07/2025

[Invited Presentation] Research on the Long-term Co-evolution of Human Ecology and Water Environment Based on Model Simulation.

Shanxi Normal University, Xi'an, China

31/03/2025

[Invited Presentation] Co-evolution between Hydro-system and Historical cities.

Harbin Institute of Technology (Shenzhen Campus), Shenzhen, China

17/03/2025

[Oral Presentation] The Evolution Process and Driving Mechanisms of the Human-Water Relationship in the Yellow River from the Perspective of Watershed Governance.

Ningxia University, Ningxia, China

19/07/2024

[Oral Presentation] The Evolution Process and Driving Mechanisms of the Human-Water Relationship in the Yellow River from the Perspective of Water Governance. (In Chinese)

1st Hydrological Process Forum, Shenzhen, China

26/04/2024

[Oral Presentation] Empowering Human-Water System Analysis through ABSESpy: An Agent-Based Modeling Framework of SES.

European Geosciences Union Assembly 2024, Vienna, Austria

19/04/2024

[Oral Presentation] Research on a coupling model of Human-Earth system -A case study of agent-based model

EGU General Assembly 2023, Vienna, Austria

25/04/2023

[Oral Presentation] Analysis of the Complexity of Virtual Water Transfer in the Yellow River Basin

Academic Forum on Ecological Civilization and Sustainable Development, China

22/11/2021

[Oral Presentation] Study on human-water relationship change in the Yellow River Basin

Conference of State Key Laboratory of Earth Surface Processes and Resource Ecology, Beijing, China 19/06/2021

[Oral Presentation] Sediment Transport under Increasing Anthropogenic Stress: Regime Shifts Within the Yellow River, China.

AGU Fall Meeting 2019, San Francisco, USA

10/12/2019

HONORS AND AWARDS

<i>Academic Innovation Award at Beijing Normal University</i>	05/2025
<i>Beijing Excellent Doctoral Thesis</i>	07/2024
<i>Excellent Doctoral Thesis (Top 1 in Geography)</i>	04/2024
<i>2nd in the 8th National Disaster Reduction and Emergency Management Academic Competition</i>	05/2020
<i>1st & Best Lecturer in the Third Academic Speech Competition of Beijing Normal University</i>	05/2019
<i>1st in the 10th Experimental Science Championship of Systems Science</i>	11/2018
<i>Outstanding graduate thesis (Top 1 in Physical Geography)</i>	06/2018
<i>Outstanding Project in National College Student Innovation Funding</i>	04/2017
<i>1st & Best Lecturer in the 3rd China University Geography Science Presentation Competition</i>	09/2017
<i>1st & Most Novel Topic in the 2nd China University Geography Science Presentation Competition</i>	11/2016

GRANTS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

<i>Seal of Excellence (95.6 points), MSCA Action, Horizon Europe</i>	02/2026
<i>Visiting Scholarship from Max-Planck Society (15,000 EUR)</i>	10/2024 - 03/2025
<i>Young Scientist Fund of NSFC (300,000 CNY)</i>	08/2024
<i>Beijing Normal University Scholarships (Four-time 1st & once 2nd prize, 58,000 CNY)</i>	12/2018 - 12/2022
<i>Graduate Student Academic Ability Competition (Twice 1st & Once 2nd, 8,000 CNY)</i>	12/2018 - 12/2022
<i>Chinese National Scholarship (Top 5%, 20,000 CNY)</i>	12/2020
<i>Sun Yat-sen University Scholarships. (Twice 1st, 10,000 CNY)</i>	12/2014 - 12/2018
<i>“1987” Economic Geography Scholarship (1,500 CNY)</i>	12/2018
<i>Guanghua Education Scholarship (3,000 CNY)</i>	12/2017
<i>Chinese National Scholarship (Top 5%, 8,000 CNY)</i>	11/2016
<i>National College Student Innovation Funding (10,000 CNY, Excellent enclosed)</i>	11/2016

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Reviewer for Academic Journals:

Peer reviewer for **33** journals (**40** reviews since 2019) across **5** fields; **25** of them are top-quartile (Q1) in their JCR category.

Water Resources & Hydrology *Agricultural Water Management* (Q1) · *Groundwater for Sustainable Development* (Q1) · *Hydrology and Earth System Sciences* (Q1) · *Journal of Hydrology* (Q1) · *Journal of Hydrology: Regional Studies* (Q1) · *Water Research* (Q1) · *Water Resources Research* (Q1) · *Frontiers in Water* (Q2) · *Frontier of Freshwater*

Sustainability & Human-Environment Systems *Geography and Sustainability* (Q1) ×5 · *AMBIO: A Journal of the Human Environment* (Q1) ×2 · *People and Nature* (Q1) ×2 · *Ecological Economics*

(Q1) · *Energy Nexus* (Q1) · *Journal of Cleaner Production* (Q1) · *Sustainable Cities and Society* (Q1) · *World Development Sustainability* (Q1)

Environmental Policy & Governance *Earth System Governance* (Q1) · *Environmental Science & Policy* (Q1) · *Journal of Environmental Management* (Q1) · *Progress in Disaster Science* (Q1) · *Regional Science Policy & Practice* (Q2) · *Utilities Policy* (Q2)

Earth & Environmental Change *Global and Planetary Change* (Q1) ×2 · *Physics and Chemistry of the Earth* (Q1) · *Geomorphology* (Q2) · *Journal of Arid Environments* (Q2) · *Quaternary International* (Q2) · *Regional Ecology and Management*

Multidisciplinary & Modelling *Environmental Modelling & Software* (Q1) · *iScience* (Q1) · *Nature Communications* (Q1) · *Scientific Reports* (Q1)

Professional consultations for:

- *Urat Center banner Grassland Ecological Research Association* 03/2024-Present
- *Yellow River Institute of Hydraulic Research, Yellow River Conservancy Commission* 08/2022

Teaching experience:

- *Extended Teaching Faculty International Max Planck Research School (IMPRS ModA).* 12/2025-Present
- *Agent-based model Seminar Series Teaching Faculty at MPI-GEA* 09/2025-Present

OUTREACH SPEECH

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- [Lecture] **Water Management in Decision Theater - Learning from Others. (Chinese Case)**
Falling Walls Science Summit, Berlin, Germany 08/11/2025
- [Lecture] **Research on coupling model of Human-Earth system - A case study of agent-based model**
Graduate course, Faculty of Geography, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China 23/04/2024
- [Invited Presentation] **Coupled human and water in the Anthropocene: Social-ecological system (SES) modeling approach**
Annual Academic Conference of Faculty of Geography, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China 24/12/2023
- [Invited Lecture] **ABSESpy, Agent-Based Social-ecological systems Modelling Framework in Python**
Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, China 20/11/2023
- [Invited Lecture] **Coupled human and water in the Anthropocene: Social-ecological system (SES) modeling approach**
Universidad San Francisco de Quito, Quito, Ecuador 15/09/2023
- [Invited Lecture] **Experience sharing in scientific data visualization**
Yellow River Conservancy Research Institute, Zhengzhou, China 17/07/2023
- [Seminar] **Evolution and driving mechanisms of human-water relationship in the Yellow River from the perspective of basin governance**
Graduate course, Faculty of Geography, Beijing Normal University, Beijing, China 23/04/2023
- [Seminar] **Flooding Collective Memory Resilience**
International Institute for Applied Systems Analysis: IIASA, Vienna, Austria 04/04/2023
- [Invited Lecture] **Look for interdisciplinary imagination**
Outstanding Student Research Experience Sharing Conference, Beijing Normal University 25/05/2022
- [Invited Lecture] **Research Methods for Complex System Management: Application of Agent-based Modeling in Groundwater Resource Management**
Virtual Lecture at Seminar of Wisdom Lab, 100+ Audiences, China 22/12/2021
- [Invited Lecture] **Interdisciplinary and Problem-Oriented Sustainability Science**
Renmin University of China, Beijing, China 22/05/2021

SOFTWARE DEVELOPED

[Leading developer] **ABSESpy: An agent-based modeling framework for social-ecological systems**

Open-sourced software on GitHub: <https://github.com/ABSESpy/ABSESpy>

23/12/2022-Present

It is based on the popular Python language and the general Mesa framework, enabling it to simulate complex interactions between agents and their environment. It has significantly improved in supporting real-world simulations.

[Team Leader] **PaperBell: Research, to be connected.**

Open-sourced software on GitHub: <https://github.com/PaperBell-Org/Obsidian-PaperBell>

2024-present

I developed this ecosystem that provides researchers with an automatic academic note-taking workflow. This open-source project currently has 216 stars on GitHub and an active community.

OTHER EXPLORATIONS

[Participated] **Zambezi River Basin Water Resources Management Survey**

NSFC funded exploration

06/04/2025-15/04/2025

[Organized] **Andes Mountains, Amazon Rainforest, and Galápagos Islands**

Personal exploration

08/2023-10/2023

[Participated] **The Second Chinese Scientific Expedition to the Qinghai-Tibet Plateau**

National funded exploration

07/2021-09/2021

[Participated] **Investigation of Grassland Ecological Degradation in Inner Mongolia**

Inner Mongolia Government funded exploration

Four times from 07/2020 to 09/2022